

skip workflow github actions

In GitHub Actions, there are several ways to **skip a workflow** depending on your use case.

1. Skip using commit message (most common)

If your workflow is triggered by `push` or `pull_request`, include one of these keywords in the commit message:

```
[skip ci]
```



or

```
[ci skip]
```



or

```
[no ci]
```



Example:

```
</> Bash
```



```
git commit -m "Update README [skip ci]"  
git push
```

The workflow will not run.

2. Skip using `paths-ignore`

Only trigger when files outside specified paths change.

```
</> YAML
```



```
name: Skip Docs Changes  
  
on:  
  push:  
    paths-ignore:
```

```
- '**.md'
- 'docs/**'

jobs:
  build:
    runs-on: ubuntu-latest
    steps:
      - run: echo "Workflow executed"
```

If only Markdown files or the `docs` folder change, the workflow is skipped.

3. Skip using `branches-ignore`

</> YAML 

```
on:
  push:
    branches-ignore:
      - develop
      - feature/*
```

Pushes to those branches won't trigger the workflow.

4. Skip using job-level `if`

Skip only a specific job instead of the whole workflow.

</> YAML 

```
jobs:
  test:
    if: github.ref != 'refs/heads/main'
    runs-on: ubuntu-latest

    steps:
      - run: echo "Running tests"
```

5. Skip using actor

Don't run if the push was made by a bot.

</> YAML



```
jobs:
  build:
    if: github.actor != 'dependabot[bot]'
    runs-on: ubuntu-latest

    steps:
      - run: echo "Build"
```

6. Skip using changed files

</> YAML



```
jobs:
  deploy:
    if: "!contains(github.event.head_commit.message, '[skip deploy]')"

    runs-on: ubuntu-latest

    steps:
      - run: echo "Deploying..."
```

Commit:

</> Bash



```
git commit -m "Update README [skip deploy]"
```

The deploy job will be skipped.

7. Skip using workflow input

Useful for `workflow_dispatch`.

</> YAML



```
on:
  workflow_dispatch:
    inputs:
      run_build:
        type: boolean
        default: true
```

```
jobs:
  build:
    if: inputs.run_build
    runs-on: ubuntu-latest

    steps:
      - run: echo "Building..."
```

8. Skip entire workflow using conditional

</> YAML



```
name: CI

on: push

jobs:
  build:
    if: "!contains(github.event.head_commit.message, '[skip ci]')"

    runs-on: ubuntu-latest

    steps:
      - run: echo "Build started"
```

Summary

Method	Skips	Best Use Case
<code>[skip ci]</code> in commit message	Entire workflow	Temporary skip
<code>paths-ignore</code>	Workflow	Ignore docs/config changes
<code>branches-ignore</code>	Workflow	Ignore specific branches
<code>if:</code> condition	Job	Conditional execution
<code>github.actor</code>	Job	Skip bot commits
Commit message check	Job	Skip deploy/test selectively
<code>workflow_dispatch</code> input	Job	Manual workflows

Method	Skips	Best Use Case
<code>paths</code> + <code>paths-ignore</code>	Workflow	Run only for relevant file changes

For interviews and real projects, the **most commonly used** approaches are:

- ☒ `[skip ci]` (or `[ci skip]`) in the commit message
- ☒ `paths-ignore`
- ☒ `branches-ignore`
- ☒ `if:` conditions on jobs or steps

